

Flat Chat

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC



Roger Elsworthy's 100

NOVEMBER 2012
THE 2012 AHOC CONCOURS D'ELEGANCE
CHARLIE'S RUN REPORT
STEVE PIKE ON BONNEVILLE
AUSTIN-HEALEYS AT SILVERDALE

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AHOC Club meetings are held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, Park Road, Rydalmere on the 2nd Wednesday of each month, commencing at 8pm. Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner at the bistro from 6:30pm.

Flat Chat Editor
Patrick Quinn



ON THE COVER

Read all about Roger Elsworthy's 100 BN1, starting on page 10.

Flat Chat

NOVEMBER 2012

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY CLUB (NSW) INC

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DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

2012-13

NOVEMBER

23-25-Tasman Revival at Eastern Creek

DECEMBER

1-AHOC Christmas Party
9-Annual Inspection Day
12-Monthly Meeting
19-Committee Meeting
25-Send the editor a photo of your car with a ribbon tied around it

JANUARY 2013

9-Monthly Meeting
16-Committee Meeting
20-Presentation Breakfast

FEBRUARY

13-Monthly Meeting
20-Committee Meeting

MARCH

29-National Rally

If you have any questions about the above events please contact our club secretary Gordon Lynas (02) 9944 4789

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

JOHN KENT (02) 9498 8193

As the year starts to draw to an end, it is worth reflecting on the achievements of the year. The social events organised by Anne Read and her helpers have been well attended, with luncheon events most popular. Anne has decided not to stand for a Committee position in 2013 and I thank her on behalf of the Club Members for her many years of work making the Club a better organisation of which to belong.

The Club's financial position has stabilised and after having non sustainable deficits for a number of years we will have a break even position this financial year when the cost carry-over from the Supersprint is taken into account. The magazine is a quality publication with interesting articles on Healeys and Austin-Healeys wherever they may be in the world.

The Club Constitution has been revised and is currently being checked to ensure compliance with the Office of Fair Trading requirements after which it will be put to the Club Membership for comment/ratification. This year all members will receive an invoice for the Club Membership Fees, so that it is in front of them and is less likely to be overlooked. While membership has suffered a minor decline as age catches up with members, it is pleasing to note the number of new members who are actively participating in the "Club".

I would like to thank all the Committee members who have been very active in organising the Club's operations for the past year; it has been a good, robust, but friendly group who have worked well together. The upcoming events for November and December are listed in the Social Section of this magazine. The Quinn's Open Garden Day is a popular Club event and their garden is outstanding.

We still have some vacancies for the Christmas Dinner on 1 December, so please come along and enjoy the fellowship. The Presentation Breakfast will be held at Stan and Jill Goodwin's home on 20th January 2013, so put that date in your diary.

The National Rally bookings have slowly started to occur, so please put Easter 2013 in your diary and join us in Canberra and help celebrate Canberra's Centenary.



HOLIDAY FUN

Austin-Healey Owners Club of New South Wales Christmas Party

This year we are celebrating the start of the festive season with our Christmas party at the Epping Club, 45 Rawson Street, Epping. It will be held on Saturday, 1st December from 7pm to midnight.

I am pleased to say that we have secured the Grand Salon which offers a warm, intimate and friendly atmosphere. Up to 80 guests can enjoy a banquet dinner, preceded by pre-dinner drinks and canapés on the Salon's private lobby area.

The cost per ticket will be \$60 per head which will ensure you a lovely dinner and a chance to dance the night away and have a wonderful evening with your Austin-Healey friends.

Tickets are now available.

Anne Read
(02) 4841 0095
anne.monaro@bigpond.com



CLUB COMMITTEE

2012

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Non-Committee Positions

Competition Assistant
John Kent

Librarian
Stuart McColl

CMC Delegate
Ray Roberts

Assoc of British Car Clubs Rep
Sue Darlington

Please do not call committee members after 9pm.

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those of the Editor or the AHOC (NSW) (Inc).



Greetings and welcome to the November issue of Flat Chat. This last month has certainly been busy for active members with not only Charlie's Run venturing to points north, but also the premier event of the year, our concours.

So it's only fitting that this issue includes not only reports from both events, but also a selection of colour photos on the 'Back Page Pics'. Congratulations to all

on Charlie's Run for their worthwhile donation to the Prostate Cancer Foundation of Australia.

On to the cover and this month we have a 100 after so many months of six-cylinder cars. Our feature car belongs to Roger and Helen Elsworthy and was bought when Roger wanted something a little bigger than the Bug Eye Sprite he was driving at the time. It was built to restore and the best result came about as he managed to keep his Sprite at the same time. You can read about it starting on page 10.

Last month I made mention of member Steve Pike having another crack at 200mph at Bonneville in the 100S powered Streamliner. I am pleased to say that I managed to sit down with Steve recently while he shared his experience with us all. You can read about that and look at a few photos starting on page 18.

"Let the Buyer Beware!" A few months back I wrote, somewhat tongue-in-cheek about a 100M supposedly for sale in Indonesia. It was a scam of course, but it's a sad indictment on some people who are trying to rip others off. Over the last week I came across another scam, but this time it was in the US. You can read about that on page 22. Remember if something seems too good to be true, it probably is.

Wedding Bells

Recently Caroline and I had the enjoyment of attending a wedding at Crackneck Lookout on the Central Coast. It was a lovely occasion in quite a spectacular setting and I am sure that everyone will live happily ever after. Of course the wedding had nothing to do with Austin-Healeys, but the groom and groomsmen were keen on older cars. Lined up near the lookout were three Datsuns sedans from the late 1970s and early '80s which certainly weren't pristine, as each looked as if it had been around the block a few times.

What I found interesting in all this was the comparisons that could be made with thirty or forty years ago. The groom was in his middle 20s and his car while cherished, wasn't worth all that much and was probably stretching his budget. No doubt he and his friends aspired to other cars and if you were to look at carsales.com.au you will see that pristine Datsuns of the same vintage are worth a pretty penny.

A few decades back when I was that groom there were cars lined

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up at the church. They too weren't worth all that much, as you could pick up a registered 100 for less than \$500 and yes we did aspire to later, more pristine examples of the marque.

Today our cars are worth way more than what we could have probably imagined back in the early 1970s and I can't help but think how good it would be if enthusiasts such as our modern day groom and his friends could be enticed into Austin-Healey ownership.

Just a few words on Conditional Registration. The annual inspection day has been changed to 9th December from Sunday 25th. The venue remains the same this year as for last year - Richard Horwood's home. On another point please do not send me your renewal form without a pink slip or notification that Neville Stirton has okayed the condition of your car. I cannot certify your car as roadworthy unless I know it is indeed just that.



As a method of increasing the funds available for the National Rally in 2013 and to assist in removing "clutter" from your garages/workshops, it is proposed to hold an eBay auction of items that may be wanted by others, but surplus to your requirements. We will need a description of the item, its condition, i.e. working/not working and a photograph so that it can go on eBay early in 2013. Patrick Quinn has volunteered to be the eBay master and can be contacted for further information on 0417 673 065.

■ MONTHLY MEETING DATE:

10 OCTOBER 2012

MEETING COMMENCED: 8.03 PM

Apologies: Mal French, Alan Mitchell, Caroline Kent, Colin Goldsmith.

New Members/Visitors: Brian and Sheryl Drew Keith McIlroy of Sydney Classic Car Hire

■ MINUTES

The President moved that the minutes of the August General Meeting be accepted. Moved: Neville Stirton; Seconded: Terry Bancroft; Motion carried. Prior to moving the acceptances of the September General Meeting Patrick Quinn advised the meeting that the minutes of the September General Meeting were taken by Alan Mitchell who was acting Secretary. The President so moved that the minutes of the September General Meeting be accepted. Moved: Vince Cessario; Seconded: Alan Whitehouse; Motion carried.

■ GUEST SPEAKER

Keith McIlroy addressed the meeting regarding Sydney Classic Car Hire. This company hires private owner classic cars to individuals for self-drive hire. The company has been in operation for a number of years and is seeking to expand its fleet of owners who want to earn some income from their classics. Refer www.sydneyclassiccarhire.com.au or call Keith on 0407 267 329 for details.

■ PRESIDENT

- AGM – Notice and Nomination papers issued with the October issue of Flat Chat. Volunteers needed to help the club. Currently the Competition Secretary position remains vacant.
- Constitution. The amended draft constitution has been reviewed by the Committee and forwarded for final legal opinion that it meets the needs of the Act. A Special resolution and supporting information will be published in the December Flat Chat and it is intended that it be presented to the February General Meeting for consideration and possible approval.
- Concours – November 4 at the Entrance. Amongst other members cars, Brian Drew's recently completed and spectacular BN1 will be on display.
- Charlie's run – location of lunch meet. The convoy will leave Berowra truck stop at 10am for a 12 noon arrival at Foreshore Park Newcastle. See also August Flat Chat
- National Rally. President called for useful parts etc to be donated for the club to auction. Donors are asked to provide a photograph, a description of what it is and its condition. Items for inclusion in proposed 'Sample Bags' for the Rally are also being sought, of which 120 items of each would be required. Members are asked to see if they can get companies to donate items.
- Raffle tickets for the Christmas draw should be returned to Patricia Bancroft as soon as possible.

■ VICE PRESIDENT

- Tassie trip vacancies for October 2013 still available. Sadly the Tasmanian Government has rejected our application for a grant.

■ SECRETARY

Mail received:

- Enquiry re hiring an Austin-Healey – passed to Sydney Classic Car Hire
- Enquiry from Canada re' sourcing an upholstery kit for a BN2 from Australia. Referred to The Healey Factory or AH Spares.
- CAMS application form for the club to hold a rally/road event in 2013 – no action required.
- CAMS – advice re' government grants – to be discussed at the next Committee meeting.

- CAMS invitation to complete a facilities survey.
- National Association of Austin-Healey Clubs of Australia – draft proposal received.

Mail Sent:

- CAMS – Voting Papers for 2013 NSW State Council elections completed and returned.
- Insurance – Nil Claims declaration returned to the insurer.

Useful Items:

- Trakman vehicle GPS tracking device - www.eyecusecurity.com

Events and Activities Notified to Club (where applicable – relisted):

- 21 October - NSW Commodore Owners Club -KIKS CAFÉ Lambridge Pl. Penrith.
- 21 October - Warragamba Damfest car & Bike Show
- 27 October - Grenfell Gold Fest
- 28 October - Western Sydney Charity Car Show – Werrington County
- 28 October - Swan Hill Show & Shine
- 28 October - Highlands Motorfest & Chevalier Fete at Chevalier college Bowral Motorfest entrants \$10/vehicle \$5.bike gates open 7:00am
- 4 November - Polo Supercar gathering at the Polo Ridges Lane Richmond.
- 6 November CMC Run to Rouse Hill Farm followed by lunch at Ettamogah Pub Rouse Hill.
- 15-18 November - Errowanbang Woolshed – blade shearing display
- 1, 2 December - Queanbeyan Swap Meet - www.qbnswnet.net
- 8-10 February 2013- Highlands Steam & Vintage Fair – Oberon
- 19-22 April 2013 - Morris 1000 Canberra Celebration and Tour

Website – new additions

- Applications for the 2013 NSW Hillclimb Championships
- CAMS Calendar update
- 2 December - CAMS Young officials programme 30 November
- 8 December - CAMS Night of Champions Dinner Ryde Eastwood Leagues Club
- 9 December - Albatross Show 'n' Shine- Nowra
- 22-24 March 2013 - Leadfoot Festival – Hahei NZ

Magazines received:

- Hundreds & Thousands (AHOC Vic) October
- Healey Torque (AHOC Qld) October
- Healeys West October
- Sidescreen October/November

Mail requiring action:

- N/R

Cards: A number of cards have been issued this month.

■ TREASURER

Members Funds as at 10 October 2012:

Westpac Cash Management Account	\$ 37,304
Westpac Business Cash Reserve Account	\$ 10,230
Westpac Term Deposits balance	\$ 57,527
Sub total	\$105,061
Deposits for Charlie's Run	\$ (21,735)
Christmas Party payments	\$ (1,020)
National Rally	\$ (394)
Club Net Funds	\$ 81,912

National Rally is account now in positive territory.

\$22,000 received as payments for Charlie's run. This will be spent as the run proceeds.

■ SOCIAL SECRETARY

31 members attended the Club meeting tonight, including 3 Austin-Healeys

Events:

- **Sunday 14 October 2012**, Claytons Run to Patonga – 11am Ferry.
- **Saturday 20-Friday 26 October**, Charlie's Run – see magazine for details
- **Sunday 4 November**, 2012 Concour d'Elegance – Memorial Park, The Entrance
- **Sunday 10 November**, Quinn's Open Garden Day – 116 Warks Hill Rd, Kurrajong Heights. \$7 entry charitable donation.
- **Wednesday 14 November**, – General Meeting, Rydalmere Bowling Club
- **Sunday 25 November**, – AHOC Vehicle Inspection Day
- **Saturday 1 December**, Christmas Party – Epping Club booked for sit down dinner.
- **Easter 2013**, National Rally Eaglehawk, Canberra (Any problems with booking the hotel, contact Anne Read.)
- 20 January 2013, Presentation Breakfast – at Goodwin's. Chamber shirts have been obtained for sale to members.

■ EDITOR

- Next month there will be a superior four-cylinder car on the cover.
- Members were reminded that we are always looking for items for the magazine, such as Alan Whitehouse's contribution in the October Flat Chat.

■ HISTORIAN

Ray Roberts mentioned Ben Sellers' 'red back' car.

■ REGALIA/PUBLIC RELATIONS

- Lots of badges available – cloth and metal varieties
- Healey posters from 2005
- Chambre shirts available.
- AHOC rear window stickers available – if you do not have one contact the Secretary/Regalia Officer to arrange for one.

SOCIAL SCENE ANNE READ (02) 4841 0095

I'm pleased to report that the bookings for this year's Christmas Party at The Epping Club on Saturday 1st December are quite pleasing. However I would very much like not to have to collect your money on the evening. So please pay for your ticket before the evening either by sending me a cheque made out to the Club or a direct deposit to the Club's account. The details are bsb 032081 ac. 123702. Please remember that if you are paying by direct deposit make sure that you include your name. The cost per head is \$60.00.

Our lunch at Patonga was just lovely and I'm sure I can say everyone who went along had a great time as it was something different. The ferry ride across to Patonga from Palm Beach will stay in everyone's memory as being beautiful due to the calm waters.

The hotel was quite crowded, so it was fortuitous that Judy Sherman had made sufficient bookings. We all enjoyed a lovely lunch and excellent service under the marquee that was set for our 24 members and friends. After lunch many set off to discover Patonga before catching the ferry back to Palm Beach.

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY- 2012

DECEMBER

Sunday 1st – AHOC Christmas Party at the Epping Club.

■ **COMPETITION SECRETARY** • Nil report.

■ **LIBRARIAN** • Nil report.

■ **CLUB REGO** • Reminder – Club inspection Day 25 November

■ MEMBERSHIP

- No new members this month
- 2013 membership will be by invoice sent to all members. Invoices will be issued in the next 2 or 3 weeks. Payment is due on 31 December.

■ CMC

- The next 2 CMC runs are
- Walk around Catalina Park 2nd Tuesday November
- Lunch at Nepean Rowing Club – 1st Tuesday December.
- Trip to UK and Europe around the Goodwood Revival meeting (September 2013)

■ GENERAL BUSINESS

- Austin-Healeys on TV. Miss Marple white over red 100 seen. Heartbeat – AH starred. Iluka singer – The Bancroft's red BJ8 features in her music video
- Club member, Steve Pike took his car to Bonneville and achieved 158 mph when the engine failed. He will try again in South Australia next year.

■ **SHOW & TELL** • Nil

■ FOR SALE/WANTED

- Factory Hardtop for four-seat roadster six-cylinder Austin-Healey – Neville Stirton
- Wanted Lucas flasher unit John Kent
- On behalf of Barbara Robinson Terry Bancroft has the Robinson 1985 Corvette for sale. NSW road registered and RHD. Contact Terry. \$25,000 ono 0409 323 133

■ RAFFLE

- Proceeds \$3.25 after paying for the raffle prize.
- Meeting concluded at 9.24pm.**



It's not too late to enjoy an evening of enjoyment including dinner and dancing. If you would like to come along, but have yet to let me know please call me or email to anne.monaro@bigpond.com. **Sunday 9th** – Annual inspection day for cars on Conditional Registration at Richard Horwood's home. PLEASE NOTE THAT THIS IS A CHANGE OF DATE FROM SUNDAY 25TH NOVEMBER.

JANUARY

Saturday 20th – AHOC Breakfast. Jill and Stan Goodwin have once again very kindly offered their home for this annual event. More details in the December issue of *Flat Chat*.

As most would know the 2013 National Rally is being organised by our Club with many hours put in by the Rally Committee to make this the best value for money Rally. So I do hope our members will make an extra effort to support this event to be held over the Easter Weekend in Canberra.

If you have any trouble, please contact me and I WILL HELP YOU.

Unfortunately we have no new members this month.

In case you didn't already know, the end of the calendar year means that membership fees for 2013 will be due.

The Club has introduced invoices for membership fees starting with the 2013 year. Shortly, you should receive or may have already received an invoice for your 2013 fees. The Club year expires on 31 December 2012, and 2013 fees are due on this date. When you receive your invoice you will notice that for fees paid by the due date, the Club offers a discount of \$10.

The information on the invoice has been taken from the last details supplied on your membership form. So please review the details included on the invoice carefully and notify me if there are any changes so our database can be updated. It's important that the Club holds the latest information on you and your Austin-Healey.

The Club has received payment for a magazine subscription for Will Sherman, who is the nephew of current members John and Judy Sherman and the elder son of Geoff and Mia Sherman who were members of the club in the 1980s. Perhaps we might see Will as a full member in the years to come.



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CELEBRATE THE CENTENARY OF CANBERRA

2013 NATIONAL RALLY

2013 AUSTIN-HEALEY NATIONAL RALLY IS BEING HELD IN CANBERRA IN ITS CENTENARY YEAR.



The National Rally to be held over Friday 29th March to Monday 1st April 2013 at Rydges Eagle Hawk Resort, Canberra will provide attendees with the opportunity to visit seven iconic Canberra locations during the Rally. The Rally programme will provide time each day to visit the location that most interests you as an alternative to going on the local tourist drives.

The locations are

**New Parliament House • National Gallery • National Library • National Portrait Gallery
Australian Museum • Australian War Memorial • Old Parliament House.**

A display day will be held within walking distance of Old Parliament House, with a slightly longer walk to The National Library, Portrait Gallery and The National Gallery. A separate visit will be required to tour the War Memorial, New Parliament House or the Australian Museum. Each location receives thousands of visitors each year and they will be looking their very best to celebrate the Centenary of Canberra as the location of Australia's National Capital. The cost per adult is \$350 which includes all meals and entertainment.

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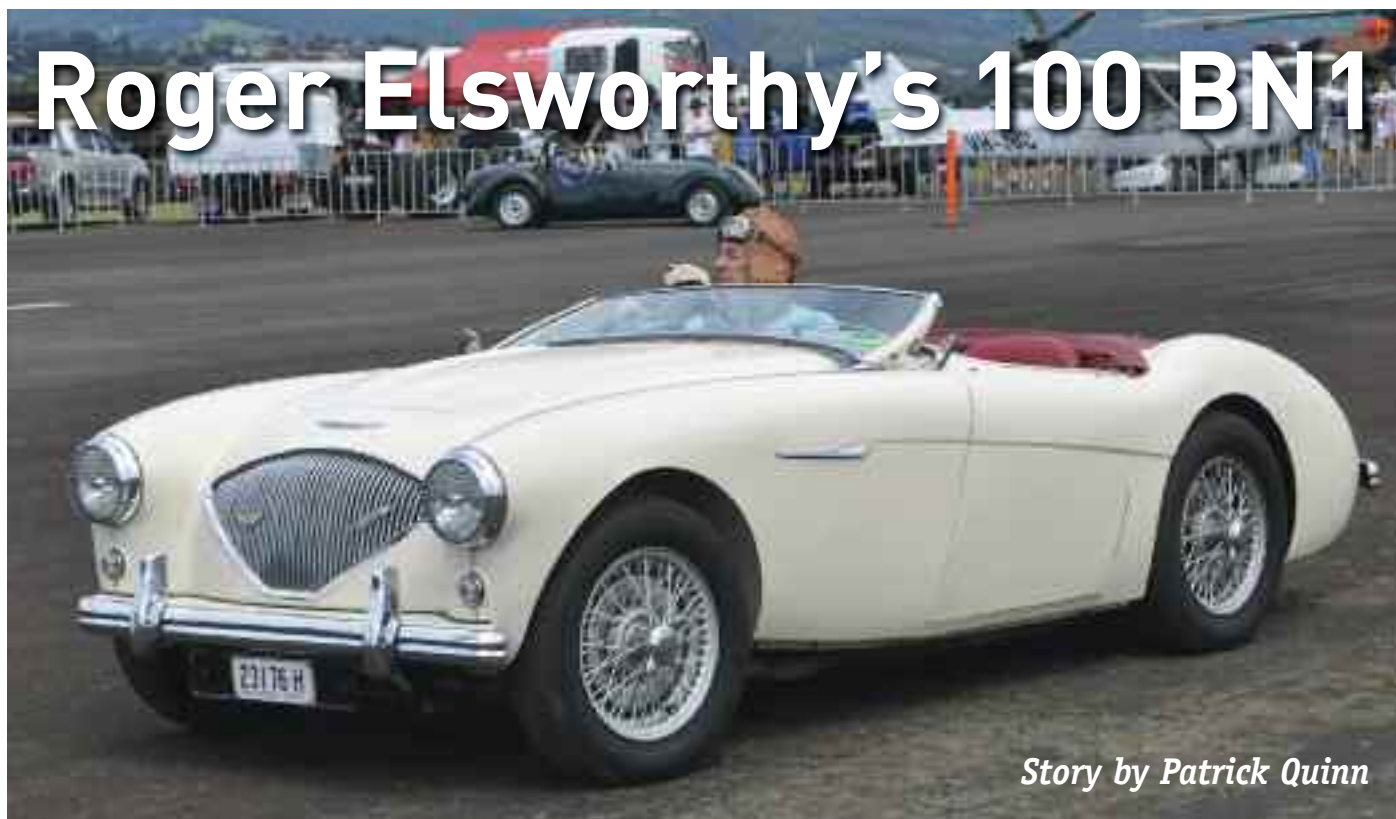


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Roger Elsworthy's 100 BN1



Story by Patrick Quinn

I hadn't seen Roger Elsworthy for some time as he hadn't been well, so it was good to see him turn up to the Club's 2011 concours at Wings over Illawarra. Yes of course he was wearing his customary leather flying helmet, goggles and gloves.

Not only was Roger looking in the peak of health, so was his car and it was good to have a chat with him recently about his time of Austin-Healey ownership.

Like most of us, Roger's 100 is not his first sports car. He started with a number of MGBs and they went by the wayside to be replaced by a Bug Eye Sprite. Now anyone who knows Roger will agree that he is not a small bloke, so he soon started to hanker for something a little larger – a Big Healey.

Keeping his ear close to the ground Roger heard of two Austin-Healey 100s for sale in Warrawong, just south of Port Kembla. So Roger found himself with a bitter sweet decision

choosing between a BN1 and a BN2.

"Actually neither was in too good a condition." Roger said in answer to my question. "The BN1 was sold new in Sydney and carried Larke Hoskins number 100/94. It had been raced fairly extensively and while drivable, it was very rough and ready. The BN2 was far worse and wasn't much more than a chassis and lots of bits. As the BN1 was a better proposition I bought that, but thinking back I should have bought both."

Restoration

So Roger's new larger Austin-Healey needed a restoration, but he was fortunate that he still had his Bug Eye and has it today.

"I knew when I bought the car that it needed a restoration." Roger said. "So it was a matter of stripping it completely and sending the major components away to be done. My friend





Geoff Perry did the body work and club member Neil McGoldrick did the chassis. When I pulled the engine down it soon became very clear why it wasn't running all that well as there was hole in number three piston."

"Although the car had spent all its life in Australia, the chassis had all the usual Austin-Healey rust, but probably not to the same extent as some cars I've seen. It needed new floors






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throughout, including the boot. The body needed tidying, especially the front shroud that had to be beaten back into its correct shape."

"I was particularly keen on finishing the car in white with red trim; however that did present a problem as I had trouble getting a red tonneau and hood. I contacted AH Spares in the UK and all they had was black, but if I was prepared to wait a few weeks they would have what I wanted in red. I waited! A highlight was the buying of the engine paint. I left it to the last moment which meant that I needed it rather urgently, so I called The Healey Factory and had it the very next day."

"It was 1998 when I got it back from the panel beater." Roger added. "By the following year I felt comfortable enough to take it on a trip so we went to Tasmania with the Club. It was running reasonably well, but the engine just wouldn't rev out. Everyone kept saying that it had to be the distributor, so I spent quite a bit of time with my head under the bonnet. Then my wife Helen suggested that I spray it with WD40. I just laughed and made some comment about it being a waste of time. Anyway Helen kept saying to spray it and I did. Of course it worked perfectly after that, with the engine revving like it should."

"We returned to Tasmania in 2005, but that was a little bit more eventful as the engine blew a head gasket. We had it repaired there while Helen and I continued on our way in a hire car."

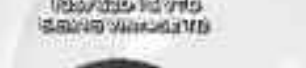
Club Runs

"I am a member of three different clubs." Roger said. "Apart from the Austin-Healey Owners Club there is also the MG Restorers Club and Sprite Car Club. Apart from the 100 and Bug Eye there are a Mk2 Sprite, a MGB, an Austin Lancer and oil on the floor."

"I don't get the 100 out all that often, but I hope to retire



A white MG Roadster convertible car is parked on a grassy area. The car has a red interior and is shown from a side profile. The background consists of a stone wall and dense green trees.

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The 2012 AHOC Concours d'Elegance

Some of the cars on display at the 2012 Concours. Glen Denning Photo.

What an excellent day was had by us Austin-Healey owners on Sunday 4th November. I am sure I speak for everyone who was there when I extend congratulations to John Kent and his fellow judges – Colin Rule, John Sherman and Stephen Clark.

While they didn't control the weather of course, it was perfect for the setting right on the water at The Entrance located on New South Wales' Central Coast. Just across the other side of the park were as many eateries, coffee shops and other entertainments that you could shake a stick at. Plus being in what was clearly a tourist area the number of spectators and passersby surely numbered in the thousands.

A second round of congratulations should go to Colin Rule who had organised a visit to his home of a number of elderly gentlemen from the East Gosford Presbyterian Aged Care facility. The visit reached the pages of the Central Coast Express, which was great publicity for the Concours. Thanks also to Don Hardie, Jim Phillips, Peter Morgan and Greg Denning who assisted.

No doubt the publicity help as throughout Sunday I lost count of the number of previous owners and members who came and said hello, sometimes wanting to know if the car they owned was still around.

I am not aware if there is an official count of the number

of Austin-Healeys present, however I did take photos of every car. Looking through them there are photos of six 100s, two 100/6 BN4s, two 3000 BT7 Mk1s, two 3000 BT7 Mk2s, three 3000 BJ7s and seventeen 3000 BJ8s. Making a total of thirty-two Austin-Healeys.

As to the standard of the cars, it was excellent. My personal view on cars is that it's up to the individual on what they do with their car. Present were two cars there that had very recent restorations – the 100 of Brian Drew and Richard Freemantle's BJ8. Both beautiful restorations and a credit to Richard and Brian. It was really interesting to compare the paths taken by both, as Brian's BN1 had been restored as to what it was like when it left the factory, while the restoration of Richard's BJ8 shows a few sensible enhancements away from original. I would be happy to have both cars in my garage.

I managed to get a leave pass from the garden for the day and took our newly acquired BJ8. The trip north in the cool of the morning was just stunning, but going home into the heat of the setting sun was not pleasant. I later mentioned this to John Sherman on the telephone and realised that he was probably wearing a wry smile while recalling the cool of his air conditioned BJ8.

John Kent's report of the judging follows.

AHOC CONCOURS D'ELEGANCE RESULTS

MEMORIAL PARK, THE ENTRANCE – 4 NOVEMBER 2012

by John Kent

This year a number of members reached the milestone of completing the restoration of their cars and the pride they had in the outstanding quality that was exhibited on the day was well deserved.

The judges on the day were Colin Rule, John Sherman, and Stephen Clark with myself acting as co-ordinator and Chief Judge. I thank them for the time spent carrying out what is a difficult task.

The results were as follows:

Master Car Class

This was judged at Colin Rule's workshop on the weekend before the display day.

The 100 BN1 owned by Brian Drew achieved the highest score achieved by any car in our Club's recent history. To validate many items I spent over an hour on the phone to Roger Moment in the USA to ensure that we did not over-score the car.

Brian's attention to detail on the car was amazing with nuts, bolts and screws all being validated, with parts no longer available made for him by Kilmartins. Brian has indicated that he is willing to share his knowledge to other 100 owners wishing to rebuild.

Best Recent Rebuild

The upholstery was still being completed on Richard Freemantle's BJ8 on the morning of the display. It is a car of quality workmanship with Richard's own touches to personalise the car. It is a credit to those involved in the restoration.

Road Car Class

This year we had two divisions: Four-Cylinder and Six-Cylinder Cars.

The four-cylinder result was a dead heat between Geoff Golding and Tony Williams. Both cars had been restored in a very professional manner and are lovely to drive. It was pleasing that both have very complete tool kits, which is unusual for four-cylinder cars.

The six-cylinder result went to Eddie Segalla for his well-known and much awarded BJ8.

Modified Healey

The BJ8 of Neville Stirton was the winner of this class narrowly from Barry Birch's 100/6 BN4.

Best Display

This was won by Colin Rule with Junior driven by Brian and Sheryl Drew's granddaughter Baillie. Many small children will remember their ride in Junior for quite some time and Colin's words "when you grow up buy an Austin-Healey".



Furthest Travelled

Barry and Karyn Birch made the long trek from Bowral to show their car. Thanks to both for your effort.

Peoples' Choice

Over seventy votes were cast, with the final trio being the BJ8 of Richard Freemantle, the Sherman's BJ8 and the BN1 of Brian Drew. The winner by the narrow margin of three votes was Richard Freemantle. (Junior received quite a few votes.)

NO award was made for the Miscellaneous (Factory) Healey this year as none were present.



Brian Drew's granddaughter Baillie enjoying 'Junior'.
John Kent Photo.

Charlie's Run 2012



*Story by Neil Thew
Photos by Allan Whitehouse*

We began the run in blistering sunshine, with a BBQ meeting point, on the Newcastle foreshore, kindly hosted by Ian and Kathryn Roughley. A good number of participants arrived in their gleaming Austin-Healeys to be treated to a BBQ lunch, salads and sweet treats more than sufficient to hold them over for the remainder of the trip to Taree.

Unfortunately we had an incident entering Newcastle where John Kent's freshly sprayed and resplendent BJ8 was rear ended at a roundabout by a distracted Ford Territory driver. A very bitter pill to swallow however it takes more than a Ford to stop an Austin-Healey and John was able to continue on the run and enjoy the remainder of the week.

On arrival during the afternoon at Taree we were greeted by the remainder of the group who had journeyed from the north and country areas. Here it was curiously notable that Paddy Hearne had trailed his Healey from Trangie to Taree to drive on the run whilst Dick Bray had driven his Healey from Dubbo (just next door) then swapped it with his son's car to drive a Toyota Aurion on the run?

We settled in to the Caravilla Motor Inn for two days of comfortable accommodation and fine food whilst we explored the Taree region. We then headed towards Armidale by different routes. Glenda and I chose to head up the coast to Urunga, and then stop at Bellingen for some lunch before proceeding on the nice drive up the mountains to Dorrigo and on to Armidale. Along the way we visited the Wollomombi Falls and Gorge, however while there was very little water we could appreciate how spectacular the area would be during heavy rain.

Armidale

In Armidale we stayed at the Deer Park Motor in at the top of the hill overlooking the city and once again it was very comfortable and offered great food. While there Coffs Harbour member Phil Bicknell had arranged for us to visit the homes of the Hardman brothers who run a local automotive dealership. Over the years they and their father before, have put together a formidable collection of unusual classic and rare cars. I cannot remember some of the older marques, as I am not old enough, but certainly represented were Austin-Healey 100, MG, Holden FJ, Falcon GT, Holden Monaro, Minis, VWs, Triumph and others of European and



Neville Stirton takes a hammer to the Kent's bootlid after it suffered a slight altercation with a Ford Territory.



Part of the collection belonging to the Hardman brothers. Yes that is a 100.



Kate Burch looking longingly at the Holden Brougham and wondering what John would say if she took it home. Judy and John Sherman looking at their camera while Larry John (background) thinks that another Alfa Romeo would go well in his collection.

American heritage right back through the early era of motoring in this country.

We spent the remainder of the day exploring Armidale. Surely a wonderful gem in country NSW, pretty much bypassed by the New England Hwy today meaning that most motor on past and miss out on some great experiences.

Armidale at this stage was under siege by bush fires burning to the east of the town and as we motored on to our final destination of Gloucester we were assailed by smoke haze and wondering if the road would be clear. Fortunately it was and we had a very enjoyable drive to Uralla for a lunch stop, then on through Walcha and down Thunderbolts Way to Gloucester for our two night stay at Bucketts Way Motel.

Gloucester is another beautiful country town with boutique shopping, cafeterias, country pubs and a fine Country Club with golf course included. It was a very warm day and while the ladies quickly went on attack, what ladies attack we patient gentlemen retired to the local beer garden for a couple of thirst quenching drinks in the shade. A layback way to spend the afternoon with great company.

The final day was spent on numerous activities including golf, drives, exploring the town or just plain relaxing in a very relaxing atmosphere.

Restored BT7 Mk2

We had a total of forty-one people attend this year's run (fourteen Austin-Healeys) and it was great to see first timers Peter and Denise Marshall from Coffs Harbour with their newly restored 3000 BT7 Mk2. Eric Rudd also came along on his first Charlie's run and had a ball.

It was also good to see Kay Britten and Sue Cairns out and about in the VW Eos Healey. Sue even went so far as to manipulate Allan Whitehouse into selecting her for the Ladies' Volvo Drivers Award when she inadvertently paid the bill for two different tables during a lunch stop.

Jim Phillips won the Men's Volvo Drivers Award when he

was apparently distracted half way through grooming and turned up at breakfast with the comb still in his hair!

Glenda and I would like to thank once again everyone for attending the run, for assistance and contributions in organising things along the way and for making it such a successful. We would also like to thank everyone for their kind donations to charity for raising a total of \$420 for the Prostate Foundation.

Hope to see everyone along again next year for a very special Charlie's run when we will be celebrating its 20th anniversary.



Steve Pike on Bonneville



The information board at the entrance to the Bonneville Salt Flats.

Back in 2008 club member Steve Pike set his sights on emulating one of the most cherished of Austin-Healey records. That was to head to the salt at Bonneville, Utah and repeat what Donald Healey and his team had done in 1954.

In 1954 the Donald Healey Motor Company took two cars to the salt – one for endurance and the other for outright speed. Both were four-cylinder cars of 2.6 litres with the Endurance car normally aspirated with twin SU carburettors while the Streamliner was supercharged. History tells us that while the Endurance car ran for 24 hours at speeds of over 132 mph, the Streamliner set an outright speed of 192.62 mph.

Both original cars were scrapped many years ago, but fast forward 54 years and Steve of Marsh Classic Restorations in Bacchus Marsh, Victoria set out to recreate both cars. These were finished in 2009 and shipped to the US. After three days on the salt the Endurance car achieved 127.07mph while after some supercharger difficulties the Streamliner set 149.06 mph with son David Pike at the wheel.

Then Lake Gairdner in South Australia called with the Streamliner setting 189 mph with David driving and 180 mph with Steve Pike driving.

RETURN TO UTAH

FC. When did you decide to return to Utah?

SP. That was in May of this year. We had to consider the cost involved and how the business was going.

FC. What had to be done?

SP. While I was happy with the speed at Lake Gairdner what stopped us going faster was that a crankshaft broke

destroying the engine. So I thought that I had to really concentrate on the bottom end of the engine. So during the conversion of a standard 1954 100 block to 100S design I had three billet main caps made along with a billet crankshaft. I also made up a flanged shaft that was bolted to the front of the crankshaft and that ran in its own external bearing. That was held in place by a 13mm steel plate bolted between the block and sump. The front of a standard crank is designed to handle around 20hp, but when you fit a blower that goes up to 100hp.

When Austin designed the engine in 1954 they used a low boost and high compression. I was doing the opposite with a low compression and around 18lb of boost which is the equivalent to a 20:1 compression ratio, which is almost like a diesel. When finished the engine was developing 330 hp at the crank at 5,000 rpm.

So from May to July I rebuilt the whole car including preparing the engine. The capacity ended up being 2,750cc



The Streamliner and the Drive Away Cancer 100 on the salt.



About to take their first run on the Bonneville salt.



If you think it looks stunning now, what must it had been in 1954?



Austin-Healey enthusiast Udo Putske from San Diego working at removing the cylinder head.

and as in the past I kept with the same Rover 5-speed gear-box and a 2.46 differential. The tyres were 6.50 x 15 on Dunlop racing peg-drive disc wheels.

FC. What about getting to the salt?

SP. Always a challenge! However this time we used a local customs agent that has offices in the US and they did all the paperwork. That made it a lot easier, but I still had to pay a non-refundable bond of \$700 to get the car into the country. There was also \$6,000 for shipping and that was one way direct in its own container to San Francisco.



Underway on the salt.

Luckily I had made friends with Bill Hyland the proprietor of On the Road Again Classics that is located just south of San Francisco. He picked up the car for me from the container depot and took it to his factory. The runs at Bonneville were due to start on Saturday 8th February and we arrived the preceding Monday. I have a Chev Suburban in the US that's left over from 2009 so we used that and borrowed a trailer.

The salt flats are a couple of days drive east from San Francisco and we set off to stay with a fellow Austin-Healey owner in a place called Diamond Springs where we prepared the car. That was followed by another long drive to Wen-

The team after the runs.



dover in Utah including two stages of exceeding an altitude of 7,000 ft. We arrived there on Friday the 8th.

Thanks to the members of the Bonneville Austin-Healey Club everything was prepared including a much needed tent. I was there with my friends Paul Flint and Brian Smith from Melbourne. My wife Helen and Paul's wife Pam were with us. Also there was Joe Jarick from Brisbane who excelled with the PR and what seemed to be mounds of paperwork. My thanks should also be extended to AH Spares in the UK for their assistance. They have been around for a long time and are still more than happy to assist someone like me when they can.

FC. So how was the first day?

SP. We were fifth on the start line on Saturday morning and everything was looking in really good shape. Cars like the Streamliner are not quite suitable for testing beforehand and in fact the engine had only seen dyno time. Everything was set to go, but unbeknownst to me the contents of the US regulation fire extinguisher had escaped. This meant that the car had to be pulled off the line and the extinguisher refilled.

In addition to our helpers there would have been about sixty Austin-Healey enthusiasts from all over the US. As usual Udo Putske from San Diego was there and always ready to wield a spanner when necessary.

At Bonneville there are two tracks that you can run on. The first goes for 7 miles for cars that can achieve 300 mph + and then there is the shorter 2.25 mile track for cars that can expect to run to 130 to 150 mph. Due to so much time wasted with the extinguisher we were allowed to use the shorter track, which also meant that we jumped the queue by about 30 cars.

FC. What was your first run like?

SP. Our first run was 149 mph, but I just couldn't get the engine to rev out to 5,000 rpm, plus I couldn't select 4th gear as the roll bar was stopping me. I thought this may be a problem, but had thought I had fixed it back in Australia when I heated up and bent the gearstick.

So apart from not being able to select either 4th or 5th, it wasn't revving either. That was due to the altitude as while the car was dyno tuned at 500 ft, Bonneville is at 4,600 ft. I had fitted an air/fuel ratio gauge and that was showing that the engine was running lean.

The next run was 153 mph, but still was in 3rd gear without it revving to where it should. So once again it was back to the pits to check the electrical connector to a solenoid that's on the boost side that allows more fuel in when at higher revs. It runs a 2 ½ inch SU, twin methanol float bowls and a ¼ inch needle. For some reason the electrical lead on the switch had broken off. A simple but annoying

problem.

FC. Was that your only problem?

SP. On Monday I noticed water coming from the back of the engine which meant that the head gasket was not sealing. In the engine the coolant runs externally or doesn't flow direct from the head to the block. The head is tightened down to 100ft/lbs and one of the head studs had worked its way loose. So it was a matter of finding someone who had a suitable size Helicoil. Luckily we found one in the same garage that was used by the World's Fastest Indian.

All that took three hours to fix, but then the heavens opened and we aborted the day as the track was covered with water. So the only choice was to go back to the hotel and enjoy a car park party with about 30 Austin-Healey owners.

When the car was started on Tuesday I noticed not water coming from between the head and block, but methanol. I took it out, managed 158mph and came back in. It still wasn't running clearly and there was the same problem with the gear shift. I tried again and once it reached 120mph I noticed a puff of smoke that came from the engine. That was the end of our time on the salt.

Close inspection revealed that the puff of smoke was when a hole was blown out of the cylinder head. The next day I removed the head and saw that not only was part of the combustion chamber melted that so was part of a metal push rod. So there was nothing else to do, but clean the salt from the car and prepare it for shipping back to Australia.

FC. What's next Steve?

SP. Certainly Lake Gairdner in February 2013. I certainly enjoyed this trip to Bonneville and I will strip the engine and fit a new cylinder. When you're out there on the salt there is something quite surreal trying to achieve 200 mph.



Even after running at Bonneville there is washing up to be done. Removing the caked on salt.

This month we have three photos to turn our attention to. Two of them as you can see are Austin-Healeys taking part in a hillclimb. I receive them from David Blanch of autotopics.com.au who would have to hold the largest collection of motor sport photos in Australia.

David said to me that they came to him in a private collection that he had recently purchased and apart from being Austin-Healeys and that they were taken in the late 1960s he couldn't say much. After a little discussion we did agree that the photos were taken near the end of the hillclimb at Silverdale near Wallacia in the foothills of the Blue Mountains.

The Silverdale Hillclimb holds a special place in the history of our club as not only did we organise many an event there, we were also on very good terms with the owners. This came about when quite a few of our members were involved in working bees to keep the climb in operational order.

The black over red car is certainly a 100/6 BN4 and the white car is a 100. While the registration numbers are a little blurred they look to be BTS 525 and BZJ 444 respectively. The 100/6 is particularly interesting as not only is it wearing racing circles, but there appears to be a bulge in the bonnet directly over the top of where the carburetors are.

The third photo comes courtesy of member Barry Campbell and it's one he took of his 100/6 when both he and Eileen travelled around Australia in 1994. Barry refers to the journey in the feature article in the February 2012 issue of Flat Chat.

It truly is a magic and evocative photo showing the Campbell 100/6 at The Pinnacles National Park in Western Australia. Looking at the photo you would have to wonder how much the roof bar weighed.



Does anyone recognise these two Austin-Healeys and the drivers?

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"Let the buyer beware!" It's good advice and is just as appropriate in your local supermarket as to when you are looking at Austin-Healeys for sale.

Throughout the world there are a number of buy/sell platforms that it's possible to sell your unwanted belongings through. The biggest of these is of course eBay, but there are others that are more geographically confined such as www.gumtree.com.au here in Australia.

In the US there is a platform called www.craigslist.org and before you even think about asking I have no idea who Craig is or even if he existed in the first place. I see that Craigslist is now operating in Australia.

Anyway appearing on craigslist.org in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania is a BJ8 for sale with the following words:

Solid car original floors and seals, excellent frame. All electrics work runs and drives very well. New stainless steel exhaust, new tires and brakes. Electronic ignition, reducer gear starter, new carpet. New foam in seats original seat covers remain. New convertible top, has side curtains. Paint very good condition. Chrome is in excellent condition. New tires.

The selling price is US\$22,411 or in money we can understand \$21,637.

Sounds amazing doesn't it, as the car looks absolutely perfect? However let the buyer beware as we all know that you cannot buy a BJ8 in that condition for that sort of money. Digging a little further through the

wonders of the internet you can come across www.classiccar.com and in there is a for sale ad from a legitimate dealer in West Palm Beach, Florida.

The words used by the dealer in their ad read:

*Metallic Golden Beige with Black Leather. *** ONLY 22855 MILES! *** Series BJ8. Ground up restoration performed by world famous Austin Healey restorer Knut Holzer. Investment Grade Restoration completed 6-11-06. Car comes with Photographic Build Book with a complete history of the restoration. Previously owned by one of our best Palm Beach clients. Extremely Rare! Don't miss out on this opportunity to join the Austin Healey Club USA with one of the finest examples available anywhere. Unique! We are export specialists and proven experts in shipping vehicles worldwide.*



CLASSIFIED ADS



FOR SALE

1965 Austin-Healey 3000 BJ8. This is an unrestored, but well maintained vehicle that runs extremely well. Fitted with new leather interior, mohair soft top, 60 spoke chrome wires and a Motolita steering wheel. Healey Blue in colour. \$68K ono. 0417 673 065.

FOR SALE

SUBARU Outback May 2010 build date: With just 54,500 Kms on the clock this car has a dealer warranty of two years remaining. It has just been serviced and in "As New" condition. Comes with 12 months registration. Price \$26,000. Please call John Kent on 0419 497 033.

Strangely the photos used by the dealer look to be of the same BJ8 for sale in Pittsburgh, but the dealer is asking US\$85,900 or Aus\$82,891. The dealer price is about what can be expected for a BJ8 in fully restored condition. As to the seller in Pittsburgh I suspect that a deposit would be asked for and that would be the last you would see of your money.

There is another saying that I particularly like and it goes like: "If it seems too good to be true, it probably is."

Of course this has no reflection on Craigslist, as it is a legitimate platform. It does have however have a reflection on those people out there who are trying to make a fast dollar on the naiveté of others.



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CHARLIE'S RUN 2012



2012 CONCOURS D'ELEGANCE



Eddie Segalla's won the six-cylinder road class with his BJ8.



Richard Freemantle's freshly restored BJ8.



Tony and Judy Williams' 100 shared first in the four-cylinder road class.



Geoff and Carol Golding's 100 shared a first in the four-cylinder road class.



Neville and Jan Stirton's BJ8 - the winner of the modified class.



Brian and Sheryl Drew achieved the highest score in recent Club history with their 100 BN1.